AzureSky		
AS009IW	Waste Management	
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Laboratory Waste Management

Applies to: All laboratory staff handling coal samples and associated materials

Effective date: 29/09/2025

1. Purpose

The purpose of this procedure is to provide clear instructions for the sorting, handling, and disposal of coal samples, plastics, and cardboard boxes generated in the laboratory. The aim is to improve organisation, minimise environmental impact, and ensure compliance with approved waste practices.

2. Scope

This procedure applies to all laboratory staff and covers waste generated in the preparation area, analysis room, storage, and furnace room.

3. Responsibilities

- Laboratory Staff: Follow this procedure when handling and disposing of coal, plastics, and boxes. Accurately record disposals in the waste tracking log.
- Laboratory Supervisor: Ensure compliance with the procedure, review waste tracking logs, and arrange collection/return of waste to suppliers or recycling facilities.
- Management: Provide resources (drums, logs, recycling arrangements) and support for training and monitoring.

4. Materials and Equipment

- Labelled drums:
  - Drum 1: Coal Residues
  - Drum 2: Plastics (e.g., sample bags)
  - Drum 3: Cardboard Boxes
- Waste Tracking Log
- Personal Protective Equipment (PPE): gloves, dust masks, overalls, steel-toed boots

5. Procedure

5.1. **Sorting of Waste**

5.1.1. After sample preparation has been completed, ask laboratory supervisor or laboratory supervisor manager whether the remainder of the sample should be kept as reference or classified as a discard.

5.1.2. Discard samples are to be transferred into drum 1, labelled *Coal residue.* The operations manager will arrange with supplier for samples to be returned to the original lot (where possible).

5.1.3. Place used sample bags and other plastic materials (tags, cable ties) in drum 2, labelled, plastics. These will be sent for recycling through approved collection channels.

5.1.4. Flatten cardboard boxes after removing their contents and place them into drum 3. Boxes will be collected separately and sent for recycling.

5.2. Waste Tracking

5.2.1. Each time waste is discarded, complete an entry in the waste tracking log, recording the following:

5.2.1.1. Date of disposal

5.2.1.2. Type of waste

5.2.1.3. Staff member's name and signature

NB: Do not store discarded waste in the preparation area. Transport waste immediately to the labelled drums to prevent clutter and contamination.

5.2.2. The laboratory supervisor will review the log weekly and sign off to confirm accuracy.

5.3. Training and Awareness

5.3.1. All staff members must attend training session on this procedure.

5.3.2. Attendance will be recorded on a attendance register.

5.3.3. Feedback will be collected from staff to improve the procedure where necessary.

6. Records

- Waste tracking log (kept on site for a minimum of 12 months).
- Staff training attendance register

7. Review

To be reviewed annually or when waste management practices change.